Babur felt that Qambar Ali grew stupider as more responsibilities fell on him. With each passing day, he had begun to degenerate into a fickle-minded manikin.

But whatever it may be, Babur gave him leave to visit his district. Earlier, Khujand had been his district but after Babur had already taken Andijān, Asfara and Kand-i-Badam were given to him in addition. Amongst Babur's begs, he was the one with large districts and many followers. None except Babur himself had so much land as he had.

Around seven weeks had passed since Babur and his men had taken refuge in the winter quarters. At Qambar's recommendation, some clans of the army too were given leave and they had retired to home. With the remaining men, Babur rode back to Andijān.

## Sulṭān Mahmud Khān Supports Tambal

During Babur's stay at the winter quarters, Tambal's communication had increased massively with the Khān in Tashkent. Although in Babur's eyes, Tambal had weakened a lot, this man was playing his diplomatic ploys to defeat Babur the soon as he could.

Perhaps, Tambal was also using his old connections to set things right for himself. His paternal uncle Ahmad Beg was the guardian of the Khān's son, Sulṭān Muhammad. He always enjoyed high favours from the Khān. His elder brother Beg Tilba, was the lord of Khān's Gate. Both these people played a crucial role in bringing Sulṭān Mahmud Khān closer to Tambal and he had agreed to bring tremendous reinforcements. Beg Tilba came to join his younger brother Tambal, leaving behind his wife, domestics and family in Tashkent.

Beg Tilba since his birth had been living in Moghūlistan. He had neither entered a cultivated land nor had he served anyone else apart from the Khāns. Tambal heard the news of Babur's army disbanding and thought that with the Khān's assured help and the arrival of his brother, he would certainly easily defeat Babur. With such positive intentions, he rode from Auzkint into 'between-the-two-rivers'. In the meantime, the news had reached Babur from Kasan that the Khān had appointed his son, Sulṭān Muhammad Khānika (Sulṭānim) and Ahmad Beg with around 6000 men, to